

A Setting up a fibre-optic LAN would be a very costly affair, and also a tedious and complicated process. You'll need a LAN card with optical fibre cable connectors, an optical fibre switch, an optical fibre patch cable and connectors. You will also need equipment to connect the cables to the connector etc, basically, lots of costly equipment. Fibre-optic connectivity is used to set up a high-speed backbone, while WiFi is used for connecting people on the fly.

WiFi is simpler and also comparatively less expensive, but definitely more expensive than a wired LAN. You will need a WiFi access point, which would cost around Rs 10,000, and five WiFi cards costing around Rs 3,000 each. The software needed to set up the access point comes bundled with the hardware.

Q I have a Pentium 4 600 MHz, 128 MB RAM and an Intel 82815 graphics controller, running Windows 98SE. I wanted to play *Halo*, but the game gave me an error that says, "Hardware acceleration may be disabled, run dxdiag." Also, when I try to run *Need for Speed: Underground*, I get an error that says, "This program has caused an illegal operation and will be shut down." What do I do?

Arshad

A You will face such problems when you try to run new games. This is because your onboard graphics controller cannot support the game that you intend playing. The minimum system requirements for *Halo* are at least a Pentium III 733 MHz processor, 128 MB RAM and a 32 MB video card that supports Hardware Transformation and Lighting. So you need at least an nVidia GeForce2 or an ATi Radeon 9200SE. You will need to upgrade to be able to play most new generation games.

Q Our educational institution wants to use 29-inch TVs as an output device instead of monitors. What computer configuration do we need for that purpose? We use a Pentium 4 2.4 GHz, an Intel GVSF original motherboard, 128 MB DDR RAM with a 40 GB hard disk, and need output to both TV and monitor.

AGS